

TT WHISTLE BLOWER

A blunt comparison of seven platforms against the ISO 37002 benchmark and Directive (EU) 2019/1937: prices, anonymity architecture and regulatory fit in Trinidad and Tobago — with an honest verdict on where we stand, and what would happen if we copied the three finalists' improvements.

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Prepared for internal strategy discussion

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1. Executive summary: the unvarnished verdict

This document answers a direct question with direct honesty: if an established insurer based in Trinidad and Tobago evaluates platforms for an anonymous whistleblowing channel today, what real options does it have, and where exactly does TT Whistleblower sit in that conversation. The analysis uses the same benchmark the institution itself defined in its internal study of August 25, 2026: the ISO 37002:2021 standard and the operational tests of Directive (EU) 2019/1937 (acknowledgment within 7 days, feedback within 3 months, and an oral channel in addition to the written one). It compares the six systems published in that study (Whistlelink, TrueSpeak, Vispato, EthicsPortal, VoxWel and GlobaLeaks) plus TT Whistleblower, using published prices, declared architecture, and the trust artifacts an institutional buyer demands.

4th / 7 position on institutional readiness (by-the-book tender)	1st / 7 position on Trinidad and Tobago local fit	USD 99 flat monthly price, no seat games
Verdict: TT Whistleblower is a conditional finalist. It wins the local shortlist; today it loses a strict institutional tender on three concrete and closable gaps.		

Three blunt truths are worth accepting before any marketing. First: the TT Whistleblower product is genuinely differentiated in one dimension a serious buyer cares about and none of the six competitors documents: verifiable integrity evidence. Our WORM audit trail with a SHA-256 hash chain and database triggers that physically block every modification or deletion is not a catalog promise; it is verifiable code, and the case integrity seal is now visible to the reporter. Second: TT Whistleblower does not offer an oral (voice) channel today, and the benchmark's operational test requires an oral channel in addition to the written one; four of the six competitors do, and in a strict by-the-book evaluation that single line disqualifies. Third: the Trinidadian market of 2026 does not buy strictly by the book, because the Whistleblower Protection Act 2024 was passed and assented to but has not been proclaimed: adoption is voluntary, relational and price-sensitive, and on that terrain TT Whistleblower competes head-to-head with anyone.

The document also answers a second question the owner asked directly: what would happen if TT Whistleblower simply copied the improvements that make the three finalists strong. The short version is arithmetic, not adjectives. Copying everything, including ISO 27001 certification and a zero-knowledge architecture rewrite, costs roughly USD 50,000-70,000 and 18-24 months, and still leaves us second on paper at the end, because certifications certify operating history and ours would be brand new. Copying the four items that appear on every procurement checklist costs almost nothing in licensing, takes four to eight weeks, and closes most of the evaluation gap. Section 6 lays out the copy matrix, the three scenarios and the items we should deliberately not copy.

2. Methodology and evaluation benchmark

The benchmark combines two reference frameworks. ISO 37002:2021 defines the principles of trust, impartiality and protection across the full receive, assess, address and close cycle. Directive (EU) 2019/1937 contributes the concrete operational tests a serious evaluator uses as a checklist: acknowledgment of the report within a maximum of seven days, feedback on actions within a maximum of three months, and availability of an oral channel in addition to the written one. A system can be excellent at encryption and still fail this checklist if it has no voice option, or if it cannot exclude a recipient with a conflict of interest from a specific case.

The local legal framework explains why this purchase is voluntary today and why that matters strategically. The Whistleblower Protection Act 2024 (Act No. 9 of 2024) of Trinidad and Tobago was passed by Parliament and assented to, but remained unproclaimed as of April 2026; that status must be re-verified because it may have changed. The Data Protection Act 2011 has only Parts I and II proclaimed, so there is no local legal floor today for data residency or detailed operational requirements. The practical consequence is twofold: the insurer buying now does so out of governance maturity rather than obligation, and the first vendor to position its platform against the local law when it is proclaimed captures the entire compliance wave. That is exactly the first-mover positioning TT Whistleblower has already built with its legislation page.

For an insurer, moreover, the buying criterion is not that of a small business. Five things weigh on the evaluation, and a vendor-risk reviewer will ask for each in writing: independent trust artifacts (ISO 27001 certification, published external penetration tests); operational impartiality (the ability to exclude from a case the recipient who might be its subject, critical in a small market where everyone knows everyone); anti-manipulation evidence that survives scrutiny in eventual litigation; total cost predictability so a board can approve it; and vendor stability (years in the market, nameable clients, incident history). Everything that follows is read through those five filters.

3. Competitive landscape: the seven systems side by side

Table 1 compares price and the oral channel, the two variables that cut a shortlist fastest. Table 2 compares what the institutional buyer is actually purchasing: anonymity architecture, anti-manipulation evidence, trust artifacts and local fit. Prices are those published by each vendor in 2026, converted to dollars at an approximate rate of 1 EUR = 1.09 USD, for an insurer of about 200 employees; they must be re-confirmed in formal quotes, and administrator or recipient seats are notoriously the least transparent element of this market: almost nobody publishes them.

Table 1 - Approximate monthly price and oral channel (insurer of ~200 employees)

System	Origin	Price/month (USD approx.)	Oral channel	Seat model
Whistlelink	Sweden	~162 (150-249 tier, EUR 149); scales with headcount	Voice recording with distortion; 24/7 phone line as a paid extra	Not published; confirm in writing
TrueSpeak	EU	~21 (EUR 19, lowest base price in the market)	Portal voice and dedicated phone line, included	Not published; verify
Vispato	Germany (HR WORKS group)	~86 (EUR 79 flat, 12-month minimum)	To be confirmed whether voice is included	Unlimited on the flat rate
EthicsPortal	EU	~45 (EUR 41.67, billed annually)	Portal recording only; no real phone line	Flat rate; confirm
VoxWel	EU	~200 (USD 1 per employee/month)	Not published	Per employee; admins usually unlimited
GlobaLeaks	Italy (open source)	~18 of VPS plus your own operating time	Audio attachments in the portal	Unlimited, with a custodian role
TT Whistleblower	Trinidad and Tobago	99 flat	No (written only; on the roadmap)	Flat; confirm seat count in writing

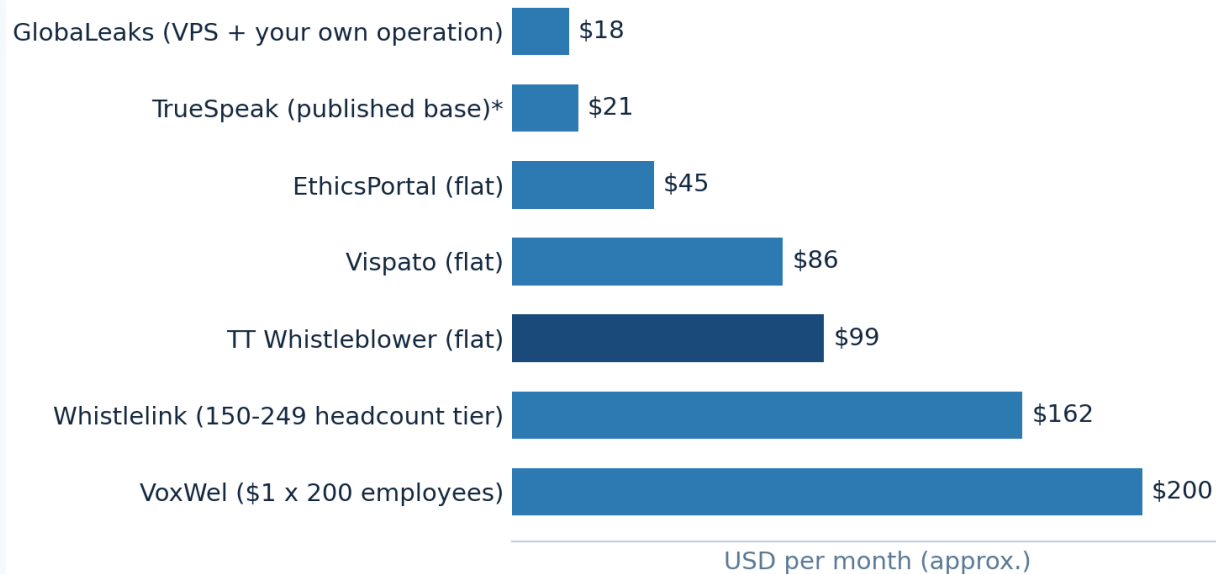


Figure 1: Approximate monthly cost in USD for an insurer of ~200 employees. Illustrative rate 1 EUR ≈ 1.09 USD; prices published in 2026, re-confirm in formal quotes. * TrueSpeak's base price does not specify included seats. GlobaLeaks charges no license fee; the real cost is infrastructure plus internal administration hours.

Table 2 - Anonymity architecture, anti-manipulation and trust

System	Anonymity and encryption	Anti-manipulation	Trust artifacts	T&T; fit
Whistlelink	Anonymous/confidential; no IP logging; metadata stripping	Tamper-evident logging (declared)	ISO 27001 certified; GDPR aligned	None; remote EU support
TrueSpeak	Confidentiality aligned to the Directive	Traceability declared	None published	None
Vispato	Privacy by design; DATEV hosting in Germany	Not published	Hosting's ISO 27001; WCAG 2.1 AA	None
EthicsPortal	Bidirectional anonymous messaging	Not published	Privacy engineering documentation	None
VoxWel	Claimed zero-knowledge, no public evidence	Full audit trail declared	None published; request whitepaper and pentest	None
GlobaLeaks	Client-side encryption to recipient keys; no IP logging; Tor	Full audit trail; published external audits	Published external security audits	Self-hosting possible in T&T; (total sovereignty)
TT Whistleblower	AES-256-GCM per tenant (HKDF); fail-closed submission; not zero-knowledge	WORM with SHA-256 hash chain + triggers blocking UPDATE/DELETE; seal visible to the reporter	Security page with claims verified in code; no ISO or external pentest	Only one mapped to the 2024 Act; local vendor; published DPA and security.txt

The number that decides conversations: of the six competitors, zero publish a mechanism by which the reporter can verify that a case was not altered. TT Whistleblower is the only one of the seven that hands the reporter an integrity seal with the case hash and a live verification of the chain. That is the differentiator to put on the table in every demo.

Reading the market in three segments. The premium segment with the most published features is Whistlelink, and it is the only one with an optional report-intake service handled by an independent first reviewer, extremely relevant for conflicts of interest in a small market. The cheap flat-rate segment groups TrueSpeak (the cheapest and the smallest vendor), EthicsPortal (cheap and friction-free, but with no real phone line) and Vispato (the best cost predictability with certified German hosting). The do-it-yourself segment is GlobaLeaks: free of license cost, the most private of all, and with the entire operating burden on you. There is also an observation from the buyer's own study that plays in our favor: if the institution has no European nexus, EU data residency is a feature you pay for and do not use, which strengthens the cheapest flat option or a self-hosted instance under direct control. Applied honestly, that argument weakens the European premium and favors TT Whistleblower and GlobaLeaks.

4. The three real finalists for a Trinidad insurer

With the five filters from chapter 2 applied (trust artifacts, impartiality, anti-manipulation, cost predictability and vendor stability), the shortlist a disciplined buyer would form today has three names. None of the three is TT Whistleblower, and it is worth saying that without euphemism before explaining where we do get in.

4.1 Whistlelink: the safe institutional choice

It is the only system on the table with its own ISO 27001 certification, the most complete published feature set (bidirectional anonymous messaging, voice recording with distortion, granular permissions, legal retention, MFA) and the extra that is worth gold in a small market: an optional report-intake service handled by an independent first reviewer, useful when the person who might be reported on is the compliance officer himself. For a board that wants demonstrable peace of mind, that is the easiest position to defend. Its hidden costs are real: the price scales with headcount (at 200 employees it runs EUR 149/month and climbs), the 24/7 phone line is billed separately, the relationship is remote with a Swedish vendor, and recipient seats have to be extracted in writing.

4.2 Vispato: the choice of the board that hates surprises

Its flat rate of EUR 79 per month with unlimited users, cases and storage is the best cost predictability among certified players, and that is exactly what a finance committee approves. Behind it sits the German HR WORKS group, with hosting managed by DATEV in Germany under ISO 27001, and it is the only one publishing WCAG 2.1 AA conformance, relevant if the channel must be accessible to public contractors. Its limits are equally clear: no public API, with SSO, custom domain and white-label branding hidden behind an Enterprise quote, a 12-month minimum, and an oral channel that remains unconfirmed. In a strict Directive evaluation, that last unchecked box is a fail risk.

4.3 GlobaLeaks: the maximum-sovereignty choice

It is technically the strongest of the seven: encryption on the client side toward each recipient's keys, so not even a database administrator sees plaintext; no IP logging; a Tor address; published external security audits; and a separate custodian role that releases the reporter's identity only through a formal process. Self-hosted in Trinidad, the data never leaves the country: total sovereignty that no European or American SaaS can match. Its weakness is operational, not technical: the license is free, but the real cost is having serious Linux capacity for patching, backups, TLS and availability, plus a demanding impartiality rule: the team that administers the instance cannot be a team that might be reported on. Most insurers do not want that operation or that responsibility, which is why it finishes third and not first.

Why the other three do not reach finalist for this specific buyer. TrueSpeak has the lowest price and an included phone line that is rare in its range, but it is the smallest vendor in the group, and the buyer's own study demands due diligence on financial stability, incident history and subprocessors before depending on it; for an insurer, that continuity risk outweighs the saving. EthicsPortal is cheap and fast to contract, but its oral channel is portal recording without a real line, and if the benchmark requires an oral channel, buying while knowing that box will fail makes no strategic sense. VoxWel is interesting for its claimed

zero-knowledge architecture, but the claim comes with no public evidence and its per-employee cost is the highest in the group at 200 people; until it presents a whitepaper and a pentest, it is a bet, not a purchase.

5. Where TT Whistleblower stands: strengths, gaps and exact position

5.1 What TT Whistleblower really has (verified in code, not in marketing)

- Anti-manipulation evidence in another class: a WORM audit trail with a chained SHA-256 hash chain and PostgreSQL triggers that physically block UPDATE and DELETE. Manipulation is not discouraged; it is prevented in the database.
- The reporter sees the proof: an integrity seal with the case hash on submission and on every follow-up check, with live verification that the case is still chained. Unique in the table; it turns the tamper-proof promise into a tangible experience.
- Serious encryption with fail-safe defaults: AES-256-GCM with HKDF derivation per tenant, and submission fails closed (503) if the key is unavailable: a report is never stored in plaintext by accident.
- Modern authentication out of the box: TOTP 2FA with progressive brute-force lockout, single-use recovery codes and WebAuthn passkeys with clone detection; at several competitors this lives in the Enterprise tier or is unpublished.
- A flat USD 99 price with no seat games: about 39 percent below Whistlelink at 200 employees, and consistent with the buyer's own observation that EU residency is a paid-and-unused feature without a European nexus.
- Irreplaceable local fit: the only platform mapped to the Whistleblower Protection Act 2024 with a public legislation page, a local vendor in the same time zone, contracts under T&T; law, accessibility designed to WCAG 2.1 AA, a Trust Center, a template DPA, security.txt and a live status page.

5.2 The raw gaps a serious buyer will find

- No oral channel. It is gap number one and it is not minor: the benchmark's operational test requires oral in addition to written, and four of six competitors offer it. In a by-the-book evaluation, this line disqualifies today.
- No independent trust artifacts: no ISO 27001, no published external pentest, no third-party audits. Whistlelink, Vispat's hosting and GlobaLeaks all have them.
- Vendor maturity risk: a one-person company, no years in the market, no nameable clients. It is exactly the filter the buyer's own study applies to TrueSpeak; you cannot demand of your neighbor what you do not pass yourself.

- Not a zero-knowledge architecture: the master key lives on the platform (by design, to enable case management), so it protects against third parties and database leaks, but not against the operator. GlobaLeaks sits one architectural tier above.
- US data residency (Vercel, Supabase, Resend) with no documented mitigation against the CLOUD Act; and no documented per-case permission control to exclude a conflicted recipient: the ISO 37002 impartiality test that Whistlelink and GlobaLeaks do pass.

5.3 The exact position, through two lenses

Seen through the institutional lens (by-the-book tender: certifications, external evidence, vendor tenure), TT Whistleblower today ranks 4th of 7. The product passes the technical filter without embarrassment and even wins the anti-manipulation category, but the evaluation stops at the empty oral-channel box and the empty independent-artifacts drawer. Through that lens the three finalists are Whistlelink, Vispato and GlobaLeaks, and no marketing spin changes it: what is missing has to be built.

Seen through the local pragmatic lens (a voluntary, post-Act, price-sensitive, relational purchase, with the ability to audit the vendor in person), TT Whistleblower ranks 2nd-3rd and is a genuine finalist. Against Vispato it offers a comparable flat price with a differentiator the German does not publish (reporter-verifiable integrity), modern authentication out of the box and a vendor you can sit at the same table with; against Whistlelink it offers roughly 39 percent savings at 200 employees and local response; against GlobaLeaks it offers the same privacy posture without the Linux operation on top. It can win that shortlist if the buyer values verifying tamper-resistance for itself more than inheriting an ISO logo from a third party, and if the oral channel is not yet a hard requirement for its voluntary use case.

The verdict in one sentence: TT Whistleblower is not today the best system on paper in the world, but it is the only one whose anti-tampering the buyer can verify first-hand, and the only one built for the law of Trinidad and Tobago. That combination wins the local market the moment the oral-channel gap closes.

6. What would happen if we copied the three finalists' improvements

This is the question the owner asked, and it deserves an answer in dollars and weeks rather than adjectives. The three finalists are strong for specific, identifiable reasons: Whistlelink for its certification and completeness, Vispato for its predictability and accessibility conformance, GlobaLeaks for its architecture and published audits. Each of those strengths is a feature, a posture or an artifact, and the three categories behave very differently when copied. A feature can be built in weeks; a posture can be published immediately; an artifact such as a certification cannot be bought quickly, because it certifies operating history.

Table 4 - Copy matrix: what each finalist's improvement costs to replicate, and whether it is worth it

Improvement (source)	What it is	Cost and time to copy	Verdict
Voice recording with distortion (Whistlelink)	In-browser audio capture attached to the case; distortion is an audio filter over the recording	USD 0 in licenses; 1-2 weeks of development on the existing encrypted pipeline	COPY FIRST. Turns the only automatic disqualifier into a green box
Granular per-case permissions (Whistlelink)	Exclude a recipient with a conflict of interest from a specific case, with the reason logged	USD 0; an extension of the existing role model	COPY. Answers the impartiality question every small-market buyer asks silently
Independent intake service (Whistlelink)	Case reception outsourced to an external first reviewer	Not software: staffing, training and liability; recurring fixed cost	DO NOT COPY. A service business that contradicts the lean model
WCAG 2.1 AA conformance (Vispato)	Accessibility conformance of the reporting portal	Already shipped in the current build	ALREADY DONE. One of Vispato's two public differentiators is neutralized
White-label, SSO and custom domain (Vispato Enterprise)	Client-branded portal on its own domain	2-4 weeks of development; sellable as an add-on tier	COPY LATER. Price it as a paid tier (USD 30-50/month), never give it away
DATEV hosting in Germany (Vispato)	A German-hosting trust signal	Meaningless outside the German market	DO NOT COPY. Honest substitute: publish where data lives and how it is encrypted
Published external audits (GlobaLeaks)	A security whitepaper and a third-party pentest summary	Whitepaper USD 0; pentest USD 5,000-15,000	COPY THE POSTURE NOW. Publish the whitepaper; run the pentest when budget allows
Client-side zero-knowledge encryption (GlobaLeaks)	Keys live only on recipient devices; even the operator sees no plaintext	Major architecture rewrite; breaks server-side case management and search	DO NOT COPY. It would break the reporter-facing integrity seal and case tooling that differentiate us
Tor onion service (GlobaLeaks)	An .onion address for maximum-anonymity reporters	Hours of work on the current stack	OPTIONAL. Cheap; niche for T&T; insurers; low priority

6.1 Scenario A: copy everything

The full list includes ISO 27001, the trust artifact both Whistlelink and GlobaLeaks lean on. A realistic budget is USD 15,000-40,000 in audits and consulting plus 12-18 months of operating history before a certificate is issued, and the zero-knowledge rewrite would consume months while dismantling the server-side case management our clients need. Add Whistlelink's intake service and the total lands at roughly USD 50,000-70,000 and 18-24 months. The uncomfortable part is the finish line: at the end of that tunnel we would still be second on paper, because certifications certify history and ours would be brand new, while Whistlelink's is years deep. We would arrive where the leaders already stand, late, with less cash and a

diluted identity: a smaller, later Vispato with a hotline surcharge.

6.2 Scenario B: copy the four checklist items

The voice channel, per-case impartiality, the whitepaper and the published-audit posture cost USD 0 in licenses (the optional pentest is USD 5,000-15,000) and four to eight weeks of focused work. With those four boxes ticked, institutional readiness moves from 4th to a virtual tie for 2nd-3rd, and local fit becomes an outright 1st with no asterisk. The pitch stops being local-and-cheap and becomes: everything the European leaders check in an RFP, at flat pricing, plus verifiable tamper-evidence that none of the seven publishes. That is a shortlist we can win, not just attend.

6.3 Scenario C: copy nothing

Today this is survivable: adoption is voluntary, the Act is unproclaimed, and the local pragmatic lens already ranks us a finalist. The exposure is timing. The day the Act is proclaimed or the regulator issues governance guidance, insurers will run checklists in which the empty oral-channel box eliminates us regardless of price, and the first vendor with published evidence and a complete channel captures the wave. Being early and cheap beats being late and perfect, but only until the law forces buying.

USD 0 closes voice channel + per-case impartiality + whitepaper	USD 50-70k cost of copying everything, including ISO 27001	18-24 mo time to arrive second, not first
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The copying decision is not how much we build; it is which gaps disqualify us and which merely decorate a competitor's brochure. Only one gap disqualifies today, and closing it is free.

The principle that falls out of the arithmetic is asymmetric warfare. Copy the features that appear on every RFP checklist, because those decide entry. Never copy the business model: per-headcount pricing is their weapon and flat USD 99 is ours, and Whistlelink's own pricing punishes exactly the 200-employee insurer we want to win. And never copy the architecture choices that would dismantle our differentiator: going zero-knowledge would silence the integrity seal, which is the one claim in this market a buyer can verify with their own eyes. The improvements that make the finalists strong are mostly trust artifacts and service layers, and artifacts compound with operating history; every month the WORM chain runs in production is a month none of the three can compress at any price.

7. The recommended path to number one

The distance between fourth place institutionally and first place locally is not closed with words but with five concrete moves, three of them free in licensing and infrastructure because they are implemented with capabilities the browser and the current stack already have. They are ordered by impact on the buying decision, not by effort. Section 6 already fixed the copy decisions; this table turns them into the execution list.

Table 5 - Gap-closing roadmap, ordered by impact

Gap to close	Why it weighs on the decision	How it is closed	Cost
Missing oral channel	Benchmark operational test; 4 of 6 competitors have it; eliminator in a by-the-book tender	Voice recording in the portal with the browser's MediaRecorder, encrypted on save and attached to the case; no external services	USD 0 in licenses; days of development
Per-case impartiality	ISO 37002 test; critical in a small market with structural conflicts of interest	Per-case permissions with exclusion of conflicted recipients and the reason logged	USD 0; part of the role model
Public security evidence	The buyer demands artifacts, not phrases	Security whitepaper with verifiable claims, a published IP/metadata policy and audit rights in the DPA	USD 0
External security proof	Whistlelink and GlobaLeaks show third-party evidence	External pentest and publication of the executive summary (not the detail)	USD 5,000-15,000, when budget allows
Local reference cases	Without nameable clients there is no shortlist	Two Trinidadian pilots with authorized testimonials, ideally one regulated	USD 0; this is commercial work

USD 0 closes voice channel + impartiality + whitepaper	3 of 5 gaps closable without spending on licenses	1 number today TT-WB is not on the shortlist the buyer wrote before calling anyone
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The real battlefield is not the demo: it is getting into the document the institution writes before it buys. Publishing this analysis with honesty is the first move to be on that list.

On execution order. The oral channel is move number one without discussion: it converts the only automatic disqualifier into a green box and, being an encrypted recording attached to the existing case, reuses the entire encryption and audit pipeline already in production. Per-case impartiality is second, because it answers the uncomfortable question every small-market buyer asks silently. The whitepaper and the pilots are the third front: when the law is proclaimed, the commercial conversation will shift from voluntary to forced, and the first player to arrive with published evidence, local cases and a complete channel captures the wave. The external pentest can wait for financing; its absence hurts, but it does not disqualify as long as the whitepaper is honest and verifiable.

8. Caveats, sources and limitations

This document is internal strategic analysis, not legal advice and not a certified security evaluation. The prices cited are those published by each vendor in 2026 and must be re-confirmed in formal quotes; the dollar conversion uses an illustrative rate of 1 EUR = 1.09 USD as of September 2026. Administrator and recipient seat counts are the least transparent element of the market and must be requested in writing from every vendor, together with four concrete questions: how many seats the base price includes and what the fourth costs; whether permissions can be differentiated per case to exclude a conflicted recipient (the ISO 37002 impartiality test); whether an external seat is supported for outside counsel; and whether the oral channel is included or an extra.

Competitor capabilities are taken from what each one publishes, not from independent testing; several market comparison articles are written by the vendors themselves, so prices are verifiable but rankings are not. The status of the Whistleblower Protection Act 2024 (passed and assented to, unproclaimed as of April 2026) must be re-verified because it may have changed, and the concrete legal position should be confirmed by a Trinidadian attorney. The TT Whistleblower capabilities described here are verified in the system's code as of the date of this document (commit 0c8d6d0), including the WORM hash-chain audit trail, fail-closed AES-256-GCM encryption, the two-way anonymous channel, 2FA and passkey authentication, and the reporter-facing integrity seal; no external security certification is claimed.